

● Section 1: Basics of Hallmarking

Question	Answer	Category
What is hallmarking?	Hallmarking is the official process of certifying the purity of gold, silver, or other precious metals as per BIS (Bureau of Indian Standards) guidelines.	Hallmarking Basics
Is hallmarking compulsory in India?	Yes, hallmarking of gold jewellery is mandatory in India in selected districts as per BIS rules.	Hallmarking Basics
What is HUID in hallmarking?	HUID stands for Hallmark Unique Identification. It is a 6-digit alphanumeric code stamped on each hallmarked jewellery item.	Hallmarking Basics
What does a BIS hallmark include?	It includes the BIS logo, purity in carats (e.g., 22K), and HUID number.	Hallmarking Basics

● Section 2: Indian Standards (IS) Codes

Question	Answer	Category
Which IS code is for hallmarking centre setup?	IS 15820 is the Indian Standard that specifies the requirements for setting up and recognizing a hallmarking centre.	IS Regulations
What is IS 1417?	IS 1417 is the standard for gold alloy purity used in jewellery hallmarking.	IS Regulations

What is IS 2112?	IS 2112 is the standard for silver alloy purity used in hallmarking.	IS Regulations
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● Section 3: Opening a Hallmarking Centre

Question	Answer	Category
How to open a hallmarking centre?	To open a hallmarking centre, apply on https://manakonline.in , submit documents, pay fees, and complete BIS inspection.	Centre Setup
What is the process to apply for hallmarking recognition?	Visit the BIS portal, register, apply under Hallmarking Centre Recognition, upload required documents, pay the fee, and schedule a lab inspection.	Centre Setup
What documents are required to open a hallmarking centre?	Required documents include PAN, GST, Shop Licence, lab layout, rent/ownership proof, machine invoices, staff qualifications, and calibration reports.	Centre Setup
How long does it take to get BIS approval?	Typically, the process takes 20–30 working days after inspection, if all documents and infrastructure are correct.	Centre Setup

● Section 4: CRM, SRM, and PT

Question	Answer	Category
What is CRM in hallmarking?	CRM stands for Certified Reference Material, a sample with known purity used to check the accuracy of testing instruments.	CRM/SRM/PT
What is SRM in hallmarking?	SRM is Standard Reference Material used for calibrating or validating testing equipment in labs.	CRM/SRM/PT
What is PT in hallmarking?	PT stands for Proficiency Testing, where different labs test the same sample to check consistency and accuracy.	CRM/SRM/PT
Are CRM, SRM, and PT mandatory?	Yes, BIS-recognized hallmarking labs must use CRM/SRM and participate in PT to maintain testing standards.	CRM/SRM/PT

● Section 5: Licensing Procedure

Question	Answer	Category
How do I apply for a BIS hallmarking licence?	You can apply on the BIS portal https://manakonline.in by submitting all required documents and paying fees.	BIS Licensing

What are the steps to get a BIS licence for a lab?	Create account → Fill form → Upload documents → Pay fee → Get inspection → Get licence if approved.	BIS Licensing
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● Section 6: Allied Services & Benefits

Question	Answer	Category
What is XRF testing?	XRF is a non-destructive test used to check the purity of gold/silver items quickly using X-ray technology.	Allied Services
What is fire assay?	Fire Assay is a traditional lab test that melts a small sample to accurately measure gold content.	Allied Services
What is laser marking?	Laser marking is engraving a permanent mark or code (like HUID) on jewellery.	Allied Services
What is photo certification?	Photo certification provides a printed/photo record of the jewellery with its hallmark and details.	Allied Services
What is a soldering service?	Soldering is a service where damaged jewellery is repaired or joined using metal alloys.	Allied Services
What is silver TG?	Silver TG refers to silver tagging, used for identifying and documenting silver items.	Allied Services

What is gold exchange?	Gold exchange allows customers to get old gold evaluated and replaced as per current rates.	Allied Services
What is induction melting?	It is a process of melting scrap or old gold/silver using induction heating for reuse.	Allied Services

● Section 7: Cost & Budget

Question	Answer	Category
What is the budget to set up a hallmarking centre?	The estimated setup cost ranges from ₹25–35 lakhs, depending on the lab size, location, and equipment.	Cost & Investment
What is the cost of an XRF machine?	An XRF machine costs approximately ₹12–15 lakhs.	Cost & Investment
How much does fire assay setup cost?	Fire assay equipment costs ₹2–3 lakhs.	Cost & Investment
What is the cost of a laser marking machine?	A laser marking machine costs between ₹3–6 lakhs.	

● Section : 8 Approximate Budget to Set Up a Hallmarking Centre

Item	Estimated Cost (₹)
XRF Machine	₹12–15 lakhs
Fire Assay Equipment	₹2–3 lakhs
Laser Marking Machine	₹3–6 lakhs
Lab Setup & Furnishing	₹3–5 lakhs
Staff Salary (monthly)	₹60,000–₹1,00,000
Other Costs (Licence, Calibration, Utilities)	₹1–2 lakhs

Total Estimated Investment: ₹25–35 lakhs (varies based on scale and city)

₹20–27 lakhs	
Andhra Pradesh	Tirupati
Arunachal Pradesh	Itanagar
Assam	Guwahati
Assam	Silchar
Assam	Dibrugarh

Bihar	Patna
Bihar	Gaya
Bihar	Bhagalpur
Chhattisgarh	Raipur
Chhattisgarh	Bhilai
Chhattisgarh	Bilaspur
Goa	Panaji
Gujarat	Vadodara
Haryana	Gurugram
Haryana	Faridabad
Haryana	Panipat

Himachal Pradesh	Shimla
Himachal Pradesh	Solan
Jharkhand	Ranchi
Jharkhand	Jamshedpur
Jharkhand	Dhanbad
Karnataka	Mysuru
Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram
Kerala	Kochi
Kerala	Kozhikode
Madhya Pradesh	Jabalpur
Maharashtra	Nashik

Meghalaya	Shillong
Odisha	Bhubaneswar
Odisha	Cuttack
Odisha	Rourkela
Punjab	Ludhiana
Punjab	Amritsar
Punjab	Jalandhar
Rajasthan	Jodhpur
Rajasthan	Udaipur
Sikkim	Gangtok
Tamil Nadu	Madurai

Tamil Nadu	Tiruchirappalli
Telangana	Warangal
Tripura	Agartala
Uttar Pradesh	Noida
Uttar Pradesh	Varanasi
Uttar Pradesh	Agra
West Bengal	Asansol
West Bengal	Siliguri
Chandigarh	Chandigarh
Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu	Silvassa

Delhi	New Delhi
Jammu and Kashmir	Srinagar
Jammu and Kashmir	Jammu
Ladakh	Leh
Lakshadweep	Kavaratti
Puducherry	Puducherry

₹25–32 lakhs	
Andhra Pradesh	Vijayawada
Andhra Pradesh	Visakhapatnam
Gujarat	Ahmedabad
Gujarat	Surat
Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal

Madhya Pradesh	Indore
Maharashtra	Pune
Maharashtra	Nagpur
Rajasthan	Jaipur
Tamil Nadu	Coimbatore
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow

₹32–40 lakhs	
Karnataka	Bengaluru
Maharashtra	Mumbai
Tamil Nadu	Chennai
Telangana	Hyderabad
West Bengal	Kolkata

Tier-1 cities: ₹32–40 lakhs

Tier-2 cities: ₹25–32 lakhs

Tier-3 cities: ₹20–27 lakhs

Includes cost of machines (XRF, Fire Assay, Laser Marking), lab setup, licensing, and staff.

❖ Other Questions :

1. How can I open a BIS-approved hallmarking centre?
2. What machines and staff are needed to start the centre?
3. Do I need NABL approval to run my centre?
4. What is the process to renew my BIS license?
5. Where can I get official testing samples (CRM or SRM)?
6. How do I record daily HUID data properly?
7. How can I upload my reports to BIS?
8. What documents should I keep for audits?
9. How often should I test or calibrate my XRF machine?
10. My test results are not matching what should I check?
11. How to train my staff for proper testing?
12. What are the new rules for silver hallmarking?
13. How do I send my jewelry for hallmarking?
14. What documents do I need to give with the jewelry?
15. How much time does it take to get hallmarked?
16. Is it compulsory to do hallmarking now?
17. How can I check if the hallmark is real?
18. Can I test the purity before hallmarking?
19. What is better XRF or fire assay testing?
20. What if my jewelry fails the test?
21. How can I register as a BIS-approved jeweler?
22. What is HUID and why is it important?
23. How can I see my HUID code?

With answers:

1. How can I open a BIS-approved hallmarking centre?

- You must apply online through the [BIS portal](#).
 - Your lab must be set up as per BIS norms, with required machines and space.
 - Submit documents like company registration, lab layout, equipment details, and staff details.
 - BIS will inspect your centre. If everything is fine, you'll get approval.
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2. What machines and staff are needed to start the centre?

Machines:

- XRF machine (for purity testing)
- Laser marking machine
- Fire assay setup (if applicable)
- Induction melting furnace
- Weighing balance
- Computer, printer, UPS

Staff:

- 1 Technical Manager (science graduate)
 - 1–2 Analysts/Testers
 - Laser marking operator
 - Data entry operator
 - Helper/Housekeeping
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3. Do I need NABL approval to run my centre?

- **Yes**, NABL (National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories) approval is required.
 - Your testing lab must meet ISO/IEC 17025 standards.
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4. What is the process to renew my BIS license?

- Apply for renewal online on the BIS portal before your license expires.
 - Submit your updated documents (test records, calibration certificates, audit reports).
 - Pay the renewal fee and wait for BIS approval after verification.
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5. Where can I get official testing samples (CRM or SRM)?

- CRM (Certified Reference Material) or SRM (Standard Reference Material) can be purchased from:
 - Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC- <https://www.barc.gov.in>)
 - National Physical Laboratory (NPL-<https://www.nplindia.org>)
 - International suppliers approved by NABL-<https://nabl-india.org>

Popular NABL-recognized CRM suppliers include:

- LGC Standards: <https://www.lgcstandards.com>
 - Merck (Sigma-Aldrich): <https://www.sigmaaldrich.com>
 - Alpha Resources: <https://www.alpharesources.com>
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6. How do I record daily HUID data properly?

- Use the **BIS HUID portal** to enter each jewelry item's:
 - Purity test report
 - Hallmark details
 - Jeweler's name and address
 - Maintain records in digital format and daily register as backup.
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7. How can I upload my reports to BIS?

- Login to the [BIS portal](#).
 - Use your hallmarking centre ID and password.
 - Upload test results, marking reports, and HUID data regularly.
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8. What documents should I keep for audits?

- Daily HUID data
 - Test reports (XRF/Fire Assay)
 - Calibration records of machines
 - Staff training certificates
 - Sample records (CRM/SRM usage)
 - CCTV footage backup (30–90 days)
 - Invoice records of incoming and outgoing jewelry
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9. How often should I test or calibrate my XRF machine?

- Internally: Daily with CRM samples
- Externally: Once every year by a NABL-accredited agency

- Keep calibration certificates ready for audits
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10. My test results are not matching – what should I check?

- Check if CRM sample is expired or contaminated
 - Ensure machine calibration is recent
 - Clean the sample surface properly before testing
 - Re-test with fire assay if in doubt
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11. How to train my staff for proper testing?

- Provide basic training on:
 - Operating XRF and marking machines
 - BIS rules and HUID process
 - Sample handling
 - Safety and accuracy
 - Arrange sessions from BIS/NABL experts or certified trainers
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12. What are the new rules for silver hallmarking?

- As of BIS update:
 - Silver jewelry must be marked with 999, 970, 925, 900, or 800 purity
 - HUID is also required for silver items
 - Same process as gold hallmarking
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13. How do I send my jewelry for hallmarking?

- Pack jewelry item-wise with a covering letter
 - Attach a job sheet with quantity, weight, and purity
 - Submit to your nearest BIS-approved hallmarking centre
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14. What documents do I need to give with the jewelry?

- Job sheet/invoice with:
 - Jeweler's BIS registration number
 - Description of items
 - Purity declared
 - Authorization letter (if sent via staff/agent)
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15. How much time does it take to get hallmarked?

- Usually **1–2 working days**, depending on volume and testing type
 - Emergency jobs may be prioritized at extra cost
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16. Is it compulsory to do hallmarking now?

- **Yes**, as per BIS rules, all gold and silver jewelry sold must be hallmarked
 - HUID is compulsory for every item
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17. How can I check if the hallmark is real?

- Use the **BIS Care App** (available on Google Play Store)

- Enter the HUID code or scan the QR to verify details
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18. Can I test the purity before hallmarking?

- Yes, you can test using:
 - XRF machine (non-destructive)
 - Fire Assay (accurate but destructive)
 - It's common to test first before sending for hallmarking
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19. What is better – XRF or fire assay testing?

- **XRF**: Quick, non-destructive, suitable for regular use
 - **Fire Assay**: More accurate, used for final confirmation
 - Both are important depending on the purpose
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20. What if my jewelry fails the test?

- You will be informed of the actual purity
 - Jewelry is returned without hallmark
 - You can refine and re-submit
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21. How can I register as a BIS-approved jeweler?

- Visit <https://www.manakonline.in>

- Fill the application for jeweler registration
 - Submit KYC, GST, address proof, and pay the fees
 - Once verified, you'll get a BIS jeweler code
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22. What is HUID and why is it important?

- HUID = **Hallmark Unique ID**
 - It's a 6-digit alphanumeric code printed on every hallmarked item
 - It links the jeweler, purity, and hallmarking centre for full traceability
 - It ensures **authenticity and prevents duplication**
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23. How can I see my HUID code?

- You can find it laser-marked on the jewelry
- Also visible in the BIS Care App by scanning or entering the code